

The Timaru Herald.

VOL. LV.—No. 5455

TIMARU, CANTERBURY: MONDAY, JULY 4, 1892.

PUBLISHED DAILY—ONE PENNY.

Shipping.

THE NEW ZEALAND SHIPPING COMPANY.
PARIS
ROYAL MAIL LINE OF STEAMERS.
Will be Despatched as under for
LONDON
Via Rio de Janeiro, Tenerife and Plymouth:

Steamer	Tonnage	Commander	Port of Departure	Date
Ruapeha	4163	Mayors	Lyttelton	1892 July 7
Kaikoura	4274	Orchard	Lyttelton	Aug. 4
Tongariro	4163	Bone	Lyttelton	Sept. 1
Avonui	4163	Stallins	Lyttelton	Sept. 29
Manatua	4274	Ward	Lyttelton	Oct. 27
Ruapeha	4163	Green	Lyttelton	Nov. 24

And thereafter every fourth Thursday.

The above steamers have splendid accommodations for all classes of passengers at moderate rates.

Passengers forwarded to Port of Departure FREE.

Return Tickets at Reduced Rates.

Warrants issued for passages from the United Kingdom to New Zealand.

Particulars may be learned on application to THE NEW ZEALAND SHIPPING COMPANY, LIMITED.

GEO. B. BULLOCK, Local Agent.

HAW SAVILL AND AMBROSE COMPANY.
Will despatch their
ROYAL MAIL STEAMERS
For London as under:

Call at
510 DE JARVIS, TIMARU, AND FOX-ROVER.

Steamer	Tonnage	Commander	Date of Departure
Island	5031	E. J. Evans	Lyttelton July 21
Doric	4758	J. J. Evans	Aug. 18
Arava	5026	J. J. Evans	Sept. 15
Coptic	4758	J. J. Evans	Oct. 13
Island	4758	J. J. Evans	Nov. 10

And thereafter every fourth Thursday.

The above steamers are of the highest class and speed, with spacious accommodations, second-class and stowage accommodation are very superior.

CARGO STEAMERS.

Vessels	Tons	Commander	Date of Sailing
Maori, s.s.	3010	Moffatt	June 22
Matatua, s.s.	3500	M'Donnell	July 1
Teaehira, s.s.	4045	Burton	July 1
Manatua, s.s.	4800	Maxwell	July 1

RETURN TICKETS AND SECOND CLASS PASSAGES at Reduced Rates.

The Steamers of this line are fitted with Opt. Chambers for conveyance of Dairy Produce.

The Underwriters are empowered to grant passages from London or Glasgow to New Zealand, payment for which has been guaranteed in the colony.

The above will be supplemented by first-class sailing vessels.

For further Particulars apply to
NATIONAL MORTGAGE AND AGENCY COMPANY OF NEW ZEALAND, LIMITED.

UNION STEAM SHIP COMPANY OF NEW ZEALAND (LD.).

STEAMERS ARE EXPECTED TO LEAVE TIMARU AS UNDER:

For AKAROA, Lyttelton, Wellington, Nelson and Westport—Omopere, s.s., on SATURDAY, 9th July, at 7 p.m.

For DUNEDIN—Omopere, s.s., on WEDNESDAY, 6th July, at 7 p.m.

For SYDNEY, via Lyttelton and Wellington—A steamer early.

For LYTTELTON, Wellington, and Greymouth—Harold, s.s., about WEDNESDAY, 6th July.

Cargo must be delivered at Railway Goods Shed Three Hours before advertised time of steamer sailing.

NATIONAL MORTGAGE AND AGENCY COMPANY OF N.Z. (LD.), Agents.

CANTERBURY FARMERS' CO-OPERATIVE ASSOCIATION, LD.

FOR LONDON DIRECT.

The fine Iron Barge
M A R I A N A,
1222 Tons Register.

THIS Vessel will sail on or about the 15th JULY. A limited amount of space is still available.

Shippers are requested to make immediate application.

C. H. INGLIS, Manager.

Insurance Companies.

VICTORIA INSURANCE COMPANY (LIMITED).
Established 1846. Re-constituted 1879.
Capital £1,000,000.

Every description of FIRE, MARINE AND FIDELITY GUARANTEED RISKS.

Effectuated at LOWEST RATES.

AGENTS IN SOUTH CANTERBURY:—
EDWARD PEARSON, Temuka.
B. H. FRANKLIN, Geraldine.
WOLSCOTT & CO., Marine, Timaru.
ROSS, SIMS & CO., Fire and Fidelity, Timaru.

NORTH BRITISH COMMERCIAL INSURANCE COMPANY.

Capital £1,000,000.

Insurance effected against FIRE at LOWEST CURRENT RATES.

GRACIE, MACLEAN & CO., Agents.

Established A.D. 1829.

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THE ISLE OF SKULLS.

(*San Francisco Examiner.*)

On the lonely, wind swept island of San Nicolas, eighty miles off the coast of Ventura County, where, as far back as the memory of man runs, hundreds of white skeletons have dotted the valleys and hillsides, local archaeologists are now busy gathering the relics of a strange, extinct race. The island is ten miles long and oval in shape, being four miles across at the widest part. Strange utensils of serpentine, sandstone, and steatite are found there among the human bones, and the island and its erstwhile inhabitants have a history so curious that it is difficult of comprehension. In 1835 the *padres* of Santa Barbara, learning that there were but sixteen of the strange Indian race then living there, determined to rescue them from the island. They went over in a sloop and succeeded, as they thought, in getting all on board. At the last moment an Indian woman returned for her child, and one of the frequent storms of the Channel Islands springing up, the sloop was driven away without her. The sloop went on the rocks of Point Conception and all on board were lost. Sixteen years later Captain George Nidexer and two men went

all on board were lost. Sixteen years later Captain George Nidever and two men went from the coast on a sloop to hunt otter off San Nicolas. On landing, they were, like Cruzos, astonished to discover human footprints in the sand. They saw no one, however, and a storm compelled them to put to sea. It was two years thereafter that the adventurous captain, revolving in his mind the sight of the footprints in the uncanny island, determined to go and discover and bring over the lonely woman of whom he had vaguely heard. Men accompanied him, and at length they saw on the surf beaten shore a woman with long, tawny hair, dressed in a queer garb of coloured bird skins, and scraping with a bone knife the blubber from a seal. They surrounded and approached her stealthily, and although suddenly confronted, she did not appear in the least afraid, but smiled, and then, falling on her knees, prayed to the sun. The wild woman offered no objection when by signs she was made to understand that she was to go with them in the boat. They reached Santa Barnaba across the rough sea, and the first thing the Indian woman saw was Dr S. L. Shaw, now eighty years old and yet living there, riding a horse. She had never seen or heard of anything like it, and thought the man and horse were one, and she knelt on the shore and offered her devotions to it. Two weeks afterward the lost in-

about on the shore and offered her devotion to it. Two weeks afterward the last inhabitant of rock-ribbed, tempest tossed San Nicolas died from eating food to which she was unaccustomed, furnished by her rescuers, and the curtain fell on her race for ever. Wild dogs had eaten her child. Her dress of red and blue feathers, a wonderful creation of barbaric hands, was sent to the Pope of Rome. Relic hunters have gathered mortars, pestles, ollas, toy steatite canoes, and other curious things there for years past, and shipped them to various Eastern and European universities. Skeletons and part of skeletons have also been collected in large numbers, but to day the bones of thousands of Indians are scattered about there some lie face down indicating that they have fallen in battle. There are so many human relics that San Nicolas known as the Isle of Skulle. "The lonely island, whose highest part is but 1040 feet about the sea," said a resident of Ventura recently, "is noted for the high artistic class of many of its relics. Had the woman rescued, then fifty-two years old; not died, a story passing strange would no doubt have been told of the race so long hemmed in by the waste of waters about. As it is, much of the story is shrouded in mystery for ever."
